Block Printing Equipment



Category: **Sewing, Textile & Handicraft** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Equipment used for developing hand block printed products; Wooden blocks used for hand block printing; Wooden printing blocks

What it is used for

To create printed patterns on fabric or paper using hand block printing equipment. To achieve clear, repeatable designs through even colour application and careful block alignment.

Main parts

- Carved wooden printing blocks
- Printing table or padded surface
- Fabric or paper
- Printing ink or fabric dye
- Ink tray or pad
- Roller or application tool

Before you start

1. Wash or prepare the fabric and allow it to dry if required.
2. Cover the work surface and secure the material flat.
3. Inspect the wooden blocks for cracks, loose pieces, and blocked details.
4. Prepare the approved printing colour and check its consistency.
5. Wear suitable gloves or apron when required by the colour product.

How to use

1. Pour a small amount of printing colour onto the tray or pad.
2. Spread the colour evenly across the block's raised design.
3. Position the block over the intended print location.
4. Press the block straight down with even pressure.
5. Lift the block vertically to avoid smearing.
6. Align the next impression with the previous pattern and repeat.
7. Allow the print to dry or cure according to the colour instructions.
8. Clean the blocks and work area after printing.

⚠ Safety

- Use printing colours according to their safety instructions.
- Avoid contact with eyes and prolonged skin contact.
- Keep knives and carving tools away from the printing area when not in use.
- Maintain ventilation when required by the product instructions.

Care & storage

- Remove colour residue before it dries.
- Clean wooden blocks gently without soaking them unnecessarily.
- Dry blocks fully before storage.
- Store blocks flat in a dry place to prevent warping.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Applying too much colour to the block.
- Moving the block while pressing or lifting.
- Misaligning repeated impressions.
- Storing damp blocks or leaving colour residue on them.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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